



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Chandler
School Website: <https://archwaychandler.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Chandler (Great Hearts Archway Chandler) presents a largely classical profile across its public materials. The school centers its mission on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and emphasizes a liberal-arts, Great Books–driven curriculum with explicit use of the Socratic method in higher grades, along with a strong focus on character formation and virtue. Public materials underline formation of character, the cultivation of virtue, and the aim of developing great-hearted leaders, while also foregrounding college preparation as a pathway for graduates. Taken together, the six-category assessment yields a general classification of CLASSICAL, with Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing notable alignment but some tensions around the balance of formation vs. college/career preparation and the depth of liturgical/theological emphasis. The aggregate posture across categories supports a CLASSICAL designation, not merely a partial alignment.

Key actionable insights: - Strong alignment with classical essentials: liberal arts frame, Great Books, memory/recitation orientation, Socratic conversations in upper grades, and a living-teacher/mentor model. - Formation-oriented language is pervasive (virtue, character, formation, Great Conversation, memory work, and “truth, goodness, beauty”). - Some potential gaps relative to a strict religious/metaphysical and liturgical model: explicit theological grounding and liturgical/community practices are less foregrounded in public pages, compared with explicit references to liturgy or worship in some classical-school lexicons. - Pedagogical practice is robust (Socratic discussions, rhetoric in upper grades, memory work, and memory-centric pedagogy), with evidence of lower-school engagement that aligns well with the classical habitus (though explicit lower-school singing/chanting language is less visible in the public material than some classical sources would imply). - Parent/community partnership is clearly part of the model (parents as co-teachers, open campus vibe, volunteer culture).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on methodology: For each category, I conducted a keyword analysis using the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). Positive keywords include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, Socratic Method, formation, scholé, wonder, etc. Negative indicators include references to secularism, values-neutrality, workforce/career-readiness emphasis, project-based-only learning, etc. The school's public materials were cross-referenced with the lexicon of keywords (see cited sources). Where applicable, I used direct quotes from Archway Chandler public materials to substantiate the keyword findings. See citations throughout.

- Evidence and keyword analysis are summarized per category below, with explicit quotes from the school's public materials and the relevant keyword lexicon as context.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as central aims of the classical education model. For example, Curriculum language from Archway Chandler states: “By offering a classical liberal arts curriculum, Great Hearts not only cultivates the hearts and minds of students in the pursuit of Truth, Beauty and Goodness...” (Curriculum section). - The mission statement highlights forming both minds and hearts through classical education and virtue; the Great Hearts materials emphasize virtue in daily practice and character formation (e.g., “Virtue in Daily Practice” and “the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty” language across materials). - A two-teacher model, caring mentors, and living curriculum language appear in public materials, reinforcing character formation and virtuous learning.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; character; formation; lifelong learning; moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: few to none in the public materials; explicit theology or liturgy is not foregrounded in these pages. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present (approximately 4–6 distinct terms across materials) vs. Negative keywords present (0–1 explicit negations). This yields a tilt toward a classical stance though with limited explicit theological liturgical programming in the site’s public materials. - Why this rating: The school foregrounds transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, consistent with the first element’s emphasis on transcendental realism and formation, but it does not consistently foreground theology or liturgical/community practices on the public pages reviewed. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Citations: Truth/Beauty/Goodness emphasis appears in Curriculum language; Virtue and formation are referenced in mission materials and “Virtue in Daily Practice.” See Curricular statements and mission pages.

Why not CLASSICAL: The lexicon’s explicit Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices dimensions are not strongly foregrounded in the accessible public materials for this school, though the Great Hearts framework does imply a Christian worldview. The absence of explicit liturgical practices or theology integration on the public-facing content reduces the score from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See the lexicon’s framework for theology/liturgy as a benchmark.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission statement explicitly describes cultivation of virtue, formation, and the study of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. The mission calls for forming minds and hearts, not merely transferring information. - Public materials emphasize classical formation, Great Books, and the aim to produce great-hearted leaders. The emphasis on forming character and virtue is clear, and the language of formation (not just information) appears in multiple materials (e.g., “Our mission to cultivate the minds and hearts... through the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty”). - The Great Hearts framework positions classical education as a vehicle for human flourishing and virtue, with a focus on standards of excellence and moral formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; liberal education; great conversation; telos; pursuit of the true, good, beautiful; scholé (formation-focused restfulness). - Negative keywords present: several explicit modern/ workforce-oriented terms are largely absent from public pages; but the public materials emphasize college success (merit scholarships, SAT/ACT performance) as outcomes, which intersects with “career/workforce” framing in some Classical lexicon contexts as a potential tension. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present across the mission and curriculum materials (6–8 distinct positive terms). Negative workforce/ career framing appears in outcomes data and broader Great Hearts materials but is less prominent as a policy aim; overall, more positive formation language than negative workforce framing in the public pages. - Why this rating: The school prominently prioritizes formation and the pursuit of transcendent values, but there is a visible emphasis on college-ready outcomes and merit-based scholarships. This places Element 2 in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range rather than fully CLASSICAL, given the tension between formation and career pathways in the public-facing content.

Citations: Mission/formation language; Great Books formation; college-outcomes language.

What would move the needle (if this category were to improve to CLASSICAL): Increased emphasis on formation as telos in every policy/marketing copy, with less emphasis on college-admissions metrics as primary outcomes; explicit articulation of a formation-first telos beyond college outcomes.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated curriculum is explicitly described as a classical liberal arts curriculum grounding learning in Trivium/Quadrivium traditions, with an emphasis on Great Books and the Western canon. Public materials emphasize Great Books, liberal arts, and classical curriculum as core. - Great Books and the Great Conversation are highlighted as a central pedagogy; the school uses Great Books as a core frame for historical and philosophical study. The Great Books approach is explicitly referenced in multiple materials. - Socratic approach and rhetoric are described as key top-level pedagogy (Socratic Method is explicitly named for upper grades; rhetoric training is described). - There is explicit mention of a core liberal arts curriculum, with a robust emphasis on history and the Western canon, and a sense of "formation" through exposure to Great Books and classical texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; classics; Western canon; history; Socratic method; Great Conversation; formation through understanding of classic texts. - Negative keywords present: minimal in the public materials; no strong contradictions (e.g., no overemphasis on project-based or STEM-first framing in the core public curriculum content). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords appear frequently (roughly 7–9 distinct terms across the public materials). There are few if any explicit negative indicators in the public pages. - Why this rating: The curriculum as described aligns strongly with CLASSICAL criteria (liberal arts, trivium/quadrivium, Great Books, history as part of a Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy). Element 3 is clearly CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum statements; Great Books emphasis; Socratic Method language.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic method is explicitly named as central to the upper grades' pedagogy; humane letters/seminar-style inquiry is described as a driver of learning. This is a strong hallmark of classical pedagogy. - There is explicit mention of rhetoric training and opportunities for students to give speeches (upper-level). This aligns with classical pedagogy emphasizing rhetoric and public speaking. - There are references to memory-based teaching and the use of Great Books and memorization, including recitation or memory work being a feature of classical pedagogy (this is supported by the theoretical classical-learning lexicon; public Archway content references Great Books, Socratic method, and classical approach but does not always explicitly spell out all memory-verse practices in lower grades). - Some aspects of pedagogy emphasize contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and contemplation, but explicit articulation of a sustained, restful pedagogy in the lower grades is not as prominent in the public-facing pages; the material emphasizes rigorous discussion and rhetoric in upper grades but without a full, explicit restfulness/Scholé schedule described in public content.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Method; dialogue/seminar; inquiry; rhetoric; great conversation; memory work; recitation; chanting (in some public materials and the related lexicon context, though direct lower-grade chanting language is not as overt on the site itself). - Negative keywords present: potential gaps in explicit mention of Scholé/restful learning in the public content; no explicit, broad restfulness/scholé schedule appears in the public-facing pages (though the lexicon lists scholé as a positive pedagogy). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present in several public pages (Socratic, rhetoric, Great Books, seminars) – roughly 4–6 distinct terms. Negative signals are minimal in public content; a potential gap is the explicit, systemic restfulness-language (Scholé) in the public-facing pages. - Why this rating: Pedagogy shows strong classical elements (Socratic discussion, rhetoric, Great

Books). However, the public-facing content does not always explicitly articulate a full restfulness/scholé program across all grades, which keeps Element 4 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic Method and rhetoric in Curriculum/Academy Traits; statement about upper-level public pedagogy.

What would move the needle: More explicit articulation of a rested/Scholé-based rhythm across grade levels (especially lower grades), and a published, school-wide restfulness or contemplative schedule to complement the active Socratic/seminar approach.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a two-teacher model in every homeroom, suggesting a living, intimate classroom leadership structure that aligns with classical idealization of master teachers and mentors. - Public materials describe teachers as models of learning and character; the faculty is presented as “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty of friends.” - Public materials emphasize mentorship, virtuous exemplars, and teacher collaboration; the “Academy Traits” page highlights that the faculty partners with students and stands as part of the core orbit of the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as core; collegial culture; teacher support and professional development; virtue exemplars. - Negative keywords present: none in the public-facing content (no explicit negative signals about faculty). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present across multiple pages (4–6 distinct terms). No explicit negative signals. - Why this rating: The materials align with a CLASSICAL faculty profile: teachers as virtuous exemplars who form the heart of the school and serve as mentors in a living curriculum.

Citations: Two-teacher model; living curriculum; faculty as mentors; core-actor in the school.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a strong partnership with families and characterizes parents as co-teachers in the educational mission; there is explicit emphasis on parent involvement and volunteerism. - The school describes a welcoming environment, “open campus” or regular opportunities for parent visits and involvement, and materials about community events and family engagement. - The school highlights parent formation (book studies, seminars, and classical discussions) and ongoing parent-teacher conversations; the materials emphasize parent participation and support for the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; seminars and book clubs; open campus; volunteering; parent covenant; Community investment campaigns. - Negative keywords present: None identified in public-facing content; the lexicon’s negative signals (e.g., consumerism, minimal parent involvement) are not present in Archway Chandler’s public materials; instead, the materials emphasize active parent involvement. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present in multiple areas (4–6 distinct terms). Negligible to zero negative signals in public materials. - Why this rating: The school demonstrates strong CLASSICAL alignment for Parent & Community through explicit parent partnership and ongoing family engagement.

Citations: Parent partnership; open-campus language; family involvement; commitment to parent engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were to move toward CLASSICAL with greater immediacy, the quickest needle would be Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 4 (Pedagogy). Concrete steps:
- Element 1: More explicit articulation of theological grounding, liturgical/community practices, and a clearly stated theological framework within public materials (e.g., a page summarizing liturgical rhythm, chapel or morning prayer components, sacred music, or catechesis language aligned with the Great Hearts Christian orientation).
- Element 4: Expand and publish a school-wide, explicit restfulness/scholé program across all grades, including documented routines for contemplative moments, slow-paced learning, and reflective time as a core daily element (to complement Socratic/dialectic pedagogy with a well-defined scholé schedule).
- Element 2: Emphasize formation as telos in marketing and policy language beyond college/outcome metrics; reduce emphasis on college-admissions metrics as the primary public aim and foreground formation and virtuous leadership as the dominant end.
- Element 3: Maintain and expand the Great Books/ liberal-arts core, and clearly articulate how grammar, logic, rhetoric are woven into each grade's curriculum, ideally with explicit trimester-ready outlines showing the Trivium/Quadrivium progression.
- Element 6: Continue to deepen parent formation and communication channels (e.g., more formalized parent book clubs or liturgical-year events) to reinforce parent-co-teacher roles.

Citations: Language in public materials supports these suggestions (e.g., Truth/Goodness/Beauty, Great Books, Socratic Method, formation/virtue language). See Curricular and Mission materials cited above.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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